

Tessera POS — Admin Settings Spec

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Admins configure everything that makes the POS look and trade like their business; Tessera keeps control of anything that affects tax, money or security. Every setting below lives in one Settings area with eight sections, and each has a default so a new client works out of the box.

Admin levels

Three levels decide who can change what. The tables below use these codes in the “Who” column.

Code	Level	Can change	Example users
T	Tessera admin	Plan, enabled modules, limits, eTIMS credentials, feature switches, locked settings	Tessera support and onboarding team
O	Owner / business admin	Branding, business details, receipts, staff and roles, payments, stock rules, notifications	Shop owner, operations manager
B	Branch manager	Own branch only: tills, printers, opening float, branch prices where allowed, approvals	Branch or shift manager

A setting marked O can also be changed by T. A setting marked B can also be changed by O and T.

Branding and appearance

Branding makes the POS feel like the client’s own system; colours are chosen from tested sets so text always stays readable.

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Business display name	Text, 40 characters	Registered business name	O
App logo	PNG or SVG, max 1 MB, shown in sidebar and login	Tessera mark	O
Receipt logo	Black-and-white PNG, max 300 px wide	None	O
App icon / favicon	Square PNG, 512 px	Tessera icon	O
Primary colour	One of 8 tested colours, or a custom hex checked for contrast	Jacaranda #5B3FA3	O
Accent colour	One of 6 tested colours	Tile Amber #F2A93B	O
Theme	Light, dark, follow device	Light (dark for bar preset)	O, per till: B
Login page style	Split screen, centred card, PIN only (tills)	Split screen; PIN on tills	O
Login background	Upload image or bottle-shelf / mosaic pattern	Pattern	O
Welcome text on login	Text, 80 characters	“Sign in to [business name]”	O
Language	English, Swahili	English	O; each user can override

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Date and number format	DD/MM/YYYY, 1,234.00	Kenyan format	O
Custom web address	Client subdomain or own domain	[client].tessera.co.ke	T (paid add-on)

Business, branches and receipts

Business details feed every receipt and eTIMS invoice, so the KRA PIN is set once at onboarding and changes only through Tessera support.

Business and branches

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Legal name, address, phone, email	Text	From onboarding form	O
KRA PIN and VAT registration	Validated PIN format	From onboarding form	T
Branches	Name, address, trading hours, contact	One branch	O
Products sold per branch	All, or selected categories	All	O
Tills per branch	Name, printer, cash drawer, barcode scanner	1 till	B
Financial year start	Any month	January	O
Currency	KSh (others later for Uganda, Rwanda)	KSh	T

Receipts and invoices

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Receipt header and footer text	Text, 3 lines each	Business name / "Thank you"	O
Show on receipt	Logo, cashier name, customer name, loyalty points, return policy	Logo, cashier	O
Paper size	58 mm, 80 mm thermal, A4 invoice	80 mm	B
Invoice number prefix	Text, e.g. KWS-	INV-	O (before first sale only)
Print behaviour	Always print, ask each time, SMS or email only	Ask each time	B
Quotation and delivery note templates	Choose from 3 layouts	Standard	O

Sales screen, stock and payments

These settings shape the daily work at the counter, so defaults come from the industry preset and managers tune them per branch.

Sales screen

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Layout	Product tiles with images, list, barcode-first	Tiles (barcode-first for supermarket preset)	B
Favourite products on first	Up to 24 products	Top 12 sellers, updated	B

Setting	Options	Default	Who
screen		weekly	
Category order	Drag to reorder	Alphabetical	O
Quick buttons	Hold sale, discount, customer, returns, price check, open drawer	Hold, customer, returns	O
Payment buttons and order	Any enabled method	M-Pesa, cash, card	O
Touch mode	Standard or large buttons	Large on tablets	B

Products and stock

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Units of measure	Piece, pack, crate, carton, kg, metre, litre, tot; with conversions	Piece	O
Tax category per product	VAT 16%, zero-rated, exempt (KRA list only)	VAT 16%	O
Low-stock level	Per product or per category	5 units	O, B per branch
Batch and expiry tracking	On or off	Off (on for pharmacy, food)	O
Selling below zero stock	Allow, block, manager approval	Manager approval	O
Price lists	Retail, wholesale, per branch, per customer group	Retail only	O
Branch price override	Allowed or not	Not allowed	O

Payments

Setting	Options	Default	Who
M-Pesa Till or Paybill	Number, shortcode, Daraja credentials	None	O enters, T verifies
STK Push	On or off	On	O
Accepted methods	Cash, M-Pesa, card, bank, credit, split	Cash, M-Pesa	O
Customer credit	Off, or on with limit per customer	Off	O
Credit sale approval	Any cashier, manager only	Manager only	O
Cash rounding	None, nearest KSh 1, 5 or 10	None	O

Staff, roles, approvals and shifts

Staff controls are where most stock and cash losses are stopped, so they ship strict and owners loosen them deliberately.

Users and roles

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Users	Name, phone, email, branch, role	Owner account only	O
Roles	Owner, manager, cashier, stock clerk, accountant, plus custom roles	The five standard roles	O
Permissions per role	Tick list per action (sell, refund, void, discount, edit price, view reports, manage	Standard matrix	O

Setting	Options	Default	Who
	stock)		
Maximum discount per role	0 to 100%	Cashier 5%, manager 20%	O
Login method	Password, PIN at tills, SMS one-time code	Password; PIN at tills	O
Password rules	Minimum length, expiry	8 characters, no expiry	O
Two-step login for owners and admins	On or off	On	O (cannot turn off for T-level accounts)

Actions needing manager approval

Action	Default
Refund	Manager approval
Void a completed sale	Manager approval
Remove an item from an open sale	Allowed; logged
Price change at the till	Manager approval
Discount above role limit	Manager approval
Open cash drawer without a sale	Manager approval
Sell below zero stock	Manager approval

Shifts and cash-up

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Opening float	KSh amount per till	KSh 0	B
Blind cash-up	Cashier counts without seeing expected total	On	O
Allowed cash variance	KSh amount before alert	KSh 100	O
Auto-close shifts	Time of day	Off	B

Industry presets, notifications and integrations

An industry preset chosen at onboarding sets dozens of defaults at once, which is what makes a 48-hour setup realistic.

Industry presets

Preset	Switches on	Sales screen	Theme
General retail	Stock alerts, barcode, M-Pesa	Tiles	Light
Wines & spirits	Sell by tot, crate deposits, age-check prompt, licensed-hours lock	Tiles	Dark
Pharmacy	Batch and expiry, expiry alerts, prescription notes	Search-first	Light
Supermarket / minimart	Weighing scale items, fast barcode checkout	Barcode-first	Light
Hardware	Sell by metre and kg, quotations, customer credit	List	Light
Restaurant / bar	Tables, kitchen tickets, tips, modifiers	Tiles	Dark

Owners (O) can change any preset default afterwards; switching preset later asks before overwriting their changes.

Notifications

Setting	Options	Default	Who
Alert recipients	Low stock, large refund, cash variance, eTIMS failure, end-of-day summary	Owner for all	O
Channel per alert	SMS, WhatsApp, email, in-app	In-app and SMS	O
SMS sender name	Registered sender ID	TESSERA	T (registration needed)
Customer SMS templates	Receipt, credit reminder, promotion	Standard wording	O
Daily report	Time, recipients	9:00 pm to owner	O
Dashboard tiles per role	Choose from tile library	Standard per role	O

Integrations

Setting	Options	Default	Who
eTIMS	On or off per branch; connection status check	On for VAT-registered	T sets up, O views status
Accounting export	CSV, QuickBooks, Xero (later)	CSV	O
Online store stock sync	On if Tessera Commerce is active	Off	T enables, O manages
Hardware	Receipt printer, cash drawer, scanner, scale, customer display	Auto-detect	B

Locked settings

These stay fixed for every client, including owners, because changing them would break tax compliance, audit trails or support.

Locked item	Why	How corrections work
Invoice numbers after a sale is issued	eTIMS invoices must stay in sequence and match KRA records	Issue a credit note from the same system
Deleting completed sales	Removes the audit trail and breaks eTIMS matching	Void or refund with approval; both are logged
Activity log	Owners and auditors rely on it to trace refunds, voids and price changes	Read-only for everyone; exportable
Tax rates outside KRA categories	Wrong rates create wrong eTIMS invoices	Tessera updates rates centrally when the law changes
KRA PIN and eTIMS credentials	Errors stop invoicing	Changed by Tessera support after verification
Colours below readable contrast	Unreadable screens cause errors at the till	Custom colours are checked before saving
Tessera support contact and “Powered by Tessera”	Staff must always be able to find help	Shown small in footer and login

Build notes

Store settings as data, never in code, so a new client is configured without a deployment.

- **One settings table with a scope:** each setting has a key, value, type and scope (platform, business, branch, till, user). The most specific scope wins: till over branch over business over platform default.
- **Settings registry in code:** one file lists every setting's key, type, allowed values, default, and which level (T, O, B) may change it. The Settings screens and API validation are generated from it.
- **Presets are bundles of defaults:** applying a preset writes business-level values; later changes by the owner are kept.
- **Every change is logged:** who, when, old value, new value; the owner can undo the last change of any setting.
- **Cache per business:** load settings once per session and clear the cache when a setting changes.
- **Branding as CSS variables:** primary and accent colours, logo URL and theme set on login, so the whole interface changes without rebuilding.
- **Settings screen sections:** Business, Branding, Receipts, Sales screen, Products and stock, Payments, Staff and roles, Notifications, Integrations.

Open questions

- ☐ Which settings are included in each pricing plan (for example custom domain and custom roles only on Pro)?
- ☐ Should branch managers be able to override prices, or only owners?
- ☐ Which language comes after Swahili, if Tessera expands to Rwanda (French, Kinyarwanda)?